

NO NEED OF SEPARATE FITNESS GEAR, THERE IS SMART FOOTWEAR

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UA HOVR connected shoe (source: sneakerfreak.com)

FitBits, Google Maps, thermowool socks and all those things you needed separately while going for a walk have now consolidated to form smart footwear, ushering in a new trend of compact and intelligent locomotion. These smart footwear can give you directions while walking, keep track of your health, tell you if you are walking enough daily and even keep you warm in winters. Here are some innovative footwear that prove that smartness can start even from the feet.

Under Armour's **HOVR** is a connected shoe. It is built of a lightweight yet durable fabric that produces an anti-gravity sensation. This means the impact on the foot every time it lands on the ground during a walk or a run is substan-

tially absorbed, reducing the fatigue time of the feet.

The shoe is made of a compression mesh called Energy Web, holding inside a proprietary foam to bring the feel of comfort. It contains a chip inside that helps it to connect with a smartphone. Download MapMyRun mobile application to share data from the shoe via Bluetooth. Every time you are out for a walk or a run,

it measures all the essential metrics like distance and time of travel, pace, number of steps taken, cadence and so on. You can compare your current data with your best data as well and network with the UA community online.

The chip is self-powered, so charging is not needed. It is embedded securely enough to handle any amount of pressure or any weather condition including heavy rain. HOVR is a great shoe for runners and fitness enthusiasts. It is available from \$110 (about ₹ 7000).

Digitsole's **Run Profiler 2.0** is not really a complete shoe. It is a smart sole that can fit in your shoes and give you the smart experience you deserve! The chips are embedded inside the sole and the whole setup is made up of a durable material that also feels comfort-



The UA mobile app (image source: www.wearable.com)